

First Light on the Trade Way

Tuesday, 7 July 2026 · plot and bookkeeping: what changed, what is canon, rulings, threads, quotes

The GM's record of the session, spoiler-tolerant: the companion to the player recap. Nothing here was shown to the players.

Loose threads & hooks live at the table

- **The Traveller's Letter is UNREAD.** Jetten pocketed it (card posted 3× but contents never read aloud). It's addressed "in a careful hand to someone in Daggerford." Decide what's in it before someone opens it at the campfire.
- **The Waterdhavian merchant.** Jetten recognized the dead high-elf woman as a person of bourgeois importance from Waterdeep; her human companion and two Lathanderite guards died with her. The party buried them and know roughly who she was — a name/consequence (family, guild, reward, someone waiting in Daggerford — possibly the letter's addressee) is an open door.
- **"Driven here from some purpose."** Thomas's History 17 got the seeded line that hobgoblins don't normally raid the Trade Way and these were scouring unfamiliar land. The party clocked it ("it's abnormal for hobgoblins to attack a trade route this close to town"). Whatever the intended truth is, it's now on the record.
- **Brother Tobin's blessing** landed as intended — the "some fields cannot fail, others starve a mile off" line about Chauntea's strange gifts is the first breadcrumb of the valley's wrongness, delivered and player-visible. Barley-Token is on Jetten's sheet.
- **Pibb & Josk, forgers,** rode north to Daggerford unmolested. Thomas knows every legitimate document-dealer in town and knows they aren't one. Recurring-NPC potential.
- **The prisoner died with questions unasked** — Thomas explicitly wanted more interrogation time and Jetten executed the prisoner first. Minor intra-party friction seed; also the party never learned whether anything else lairs deeper in the cave (there isn't — DM said natural cave, nothing else of interest).

Bookkeeping — applied at the table (verify in world)

- **Vault split (Item Piles, ~00:23–00:27):** Morgash — Ember-Touched Greatsword, Keoghtom's Ointment, 207 gp (left old greatsword in chest) · Gren — Wand of the War Mage +1, Periapt of Wound Closure, 207 gp · Thomas — +1 Shield, Stone of Good Luck, Cloak of Protection, 206 gp (left spare shield) · Jetten — Quiver of Ehlonna, 2× +1 Dagger, 414 gp.
- **Cave loot (Item Piles, ~02:32–02:44):** Thomas — Rose-Gold Longsword (**attuned overnight → identified as First Light**), Hooded Lantern, Rations, Small Cask of Southern Wine, Bolt of Fine Cloth, Backpack, Traveler's Clothes · Jetten — Traveller's Letter, Healer's Kit · Gren — Driftglobe, Pouch of Cut Gems (90 gp when sold) · Morgash — Small Cask of Southern Wine, Potion of Healing · coin pouch split: 15 gp + 10 sp each.
- **No level-up** (milestone = per shard; 0 shards). All four PCs long rested (new day).
- **✓ NaN-attunement watch — AUDIT RUN 2026-07-08, corruption confirmed + repaired:** 16 fresh attunement: "NaN" (every non-loot item the two Item Piles batches moved — 14 across all four PCs + the old Greatsword/Shield deposited in the vault pile). All captured pre-scrub, then repaired to correct values; flags forensic pinned the cause to the Item Piles transfer path itself (18/18 corrupted items carry its transfer flag; controls clean; v3.3.2). Evidence in the notes repo: evidence/nan-attunement-2026-07-08-session1-loot.md. **DM follow-ups from the audit:** ① Thomas must ATTUNE Cloak of Protection + Stone of Good Luck — the corruption had been leaking their bonuses without attunement; his AC drops to 20 until he attunes (First Light + both = exactly his 3 slots). ② Sheet vs notes discrepancies: Jetten has ONE +1 Dagger (notes say 2×); the vault sharing log recorded Jetten taking 207 gp (notes say 414). ③ Re-run the audit after any session with Item Piles transfers.

Rules & house rulings made at the table (now precedent)

- **All healing is doubled** (stated as standing house rule; Jetten's Healing Word $2d4+3=5 \rightarrow 10$ applied, hobgoblin shaman's 5 also doubled? — DM applied doubling to PC healing; confirm it's meant to apply to monsters too).
- **Re-roll rule:** a roll made with the wrong mode (adv/dis) is re-rolled ("if you don't do a roll right, you have to do it over").
- **Non-lethal melee** (2024 KO rule) used for the pommel-strike subdual; Gren's Intimidation ran as opposed check vs. the hobgoblin's Wisdom.

- DM discretion advantage examples set: Thomas gets advantage on Insight/Investigation in his scribe wheelhouse (forgers, documents, well-appointed guards).

Fix-list (DM said "I have a whole list of stuff to fix" — observed items)

- **Hobgoblin Archer longbow had a bogus 3d4 poison rider** — caused a monster crit for ~15 on Morgash, corrected live to 8. DM fixed the actor mid-fight; **verify the Warrior/Captain items too** (the Captain's greatsword card also showed a 1d6 poison rider — intended? The Shaman's Vine Staff poison is legit).
- **Bless didn't expire on long rest** ("How interesting — the Bless spells still on despite you all rested") — stale effect cleanup needed.
- **Light spell expired prematurely** mid-dungeon per Gren ("it should not have expired") — recast.
- **Combat tracker glitched** when adding combatants (DM had to work around); the Shaman was meant to be in from the start but entered the tracker late — in-fiction it arrived mid-fight.
- **Gren's metamagic roster needs reconciling:** player expected Subtle Spell; sheet had Careful (not Subtle) at first, then DM found Subtle "in other features" sorted oddly; in-fight Gren said "I don't have Twin Spell." World-state doc says Careful+Twinned — sheet, player intent, and doc disagree. Settle the two options officially (note: Empowered was the standing suggestion for next level).
- **Browser support:** Safari and DuckDuckGo broke card pop-ups/UI for Robert and Drew — both moved to Chrome and everything worked. Tell players: **Chrome only.**
- **Vision setting** was wrong on at least one token ("Vision was not set properly") — fixed live.
- **Jetten's name:** canon is "**Jetten Elisedil**" (the actor sheet is master). Actor sheet, bio journal, Thomas's backstory and chat alias all read "Elisedil"; placed-token nameplates read "Jetten" per the first-name house convention. The "Ellisedell" reading above was a typo in a prep note — it never existed in the world.
- Discord audio: Drew's echo fixed via Voice Isolation setting; he also had one-way audio twice (log out/in fixed it). First-session noise, no action needed beyond Chrome note.

Quotes of the night

- *"I take no orders from no one but my captain. ... I am captain now."* — the last hobgoblin, pointing at the corpse, minutes before Jetten's shortsword
- *"The lady's been strange with her gifts of late. Some fields simply cannot fail; others starve a mile off."* — Brother Tobin, priest of Chauntea

- *"I know that you want to retire, but perhaps in the hag coven we can find you a spouse. Seems like the perfect place for you."* — Gren, to Morgash
- *"They will feel the wrath, and you will have your back. Vengeance, I swear."* — Morgash
- *"The blessings of Moonbow be upon you. Look at us — orcs and elves being friends."* — Jetten, healing Morgash mid-fight
- *"Light a candle, don't curse the darkness, as they say."* — Jetten, as Gren's Light blew his stealth
- *"Man, if I keep rolling like this, I need some more whiskey."* — Jetten
- *"Finally hit something. Finally!"* — Morgash, after an evening of Graze chip damage
- *"I won't take anything from the dead who follow the same god as me — out of respect."* — Thomas

Scheduling

- Next session **Tuesday 2026-07-14** (Tuesday confirmed as the slot).
- Two players travel in the weeks after the 14th; plan a break or drop-in coverage.

GM-only. Compiled from the transcript, the chat log and the live sheets by the session scribe.